

Copilot App and Canvases

Shared artifacts for people and agents

The Customize area

Use the Copilot App to find approved:

- plugins;
- skills;
- MCP servers;
- canvases.

Verify the surface, policy, and data boundary before a live exercise.

Pick the smallest fit

Need	Use
Convention	Instructions
Procedure	Skill
Specialist role	Custom agent
External capability	MCP
Shared artifact	Canvas
Distributed package	Plugin

A canvas shares state

People work directly on the artifact.

The agent can read or change the same state through bounded capabilities.

Use a canvas when work needs visible progress, direct steering, or a handoff artifact.

A canvas is not the source system

The canvas helps a team decide and coordinate. It should not quietly replace the system that owns the work.

If the system owns	The canvas should show
Issue state	A labeled planning view
Approval record	A link or reference to the decision
Customer data	Only approved, minimized fields

When the two views disagree, verify the source system and correct or explain the canvas. Do not assume the more convenient view is right.

Bound agent authority by action

An agent capability should map to one safe, explainable action.

Capability	Safe example	Boundary
Read	Summarize items waiting for review	Cannot infer missing evidence
Propose	Suggest a status update	Human accepts the change
Update	Mark one named item ready	Evidence is required
Act externally	None in this lab	Excluded by design

If an action needs a broad verb such as "manage" or "handle," the contract is probably too vague for a shared artifact.

Design for recovery

Trainers should show learners how the canvas fails safely:

1. A user enters a status that is not allowed.
2. The canvas rejects it and shows the permitted values.
3. An item has no evidence, so `ready` remains unavailable.
4. The owner corrects the record or returns it to an earlier status.

A canvas needs an owner, a clear source of truth, and a way to retire it when the work ends. Otherwise it becomes another stale dashboard.

Design the contract

State: item, status, review flag, evidence

User actions: add, update status, flag review

Agent capabilities: read board, update named item

Validation: accepted statuses, evidence before ready

Boundary: synthetic data, no external systems

Create a bounded canvas

```
/create-canvas
```

```
Create a delivery-readiness canvas for synthetic work items.  
People can add an item and update its status.  
The agent can read the board and update one named item.  
Reject unknown statuses. Require evidence before ready.  
Do not connect external systems.
```

Review before sharing

- State and artifact storage
- User actions and agent capabilities
- Data classification and approvals
- Validation and reviewer
- Owner, fallback, and removal

Lab

Create or simulate a delivery-readiness canvas. Review it with a peer before sharing it.